

» NIGHTJARS

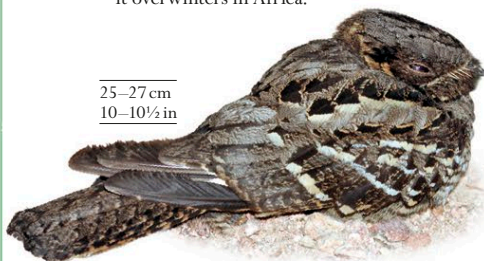


26–28 cm
10–11 in

EUROPEAN NIGHTJAR*Caprimulgus europaeus*

F: Caprimulgidae

Like many nightjars of northern temperate regions, this species is migratory. Found in W. Eurasian heath and woodland, it overwinters in Africa.



25–27 cm
10–10½ in

LARGE-TAILED NIGHTJAR*Caprimulgus macrurus*

F: Caprimulgidae

Among the most widespread of the Old World nightjars, this species ranges from Pakistan to Australia and New Guinea.



25–35 cm
10–14 in

MADAGASCAR NIGHTJAR*Caprimulgus madagascariensis*

F: Caprimulgidae

This nightjar from Madagascar and Aldabra Island (Seychelles) has a call that resembles the sound of a marble bouncing on a hard floor.



21 cm
8½ in

STANDARD-WINGED NIGHTJAR*Macrodipteryx longipennis*

F: Caprimulgidae

This African species eats insects, including moths and beetles. Breeding males have flag-like flight feathers, longer than the body, which they raise in courtship displays.



reddish brown collar

20 cm
8 in

SPOT-TAILED NIGHTJAR*Caprimulgus maculicaudus*

F: Caprimulgidae

Found from Mexico to Paraguay, this species may be more closely related to tropical American nighthawks than Old World nightjars.

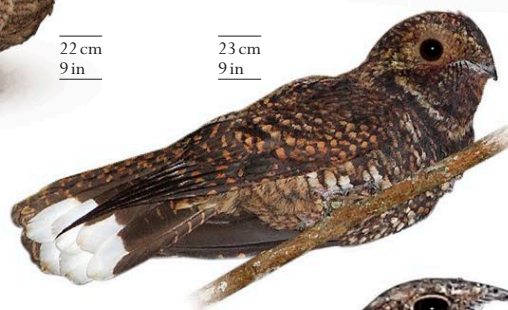


22 cm
9 in

PLAIN NIGHTJAR*Caprimulgus inornatus*

F: Caprimulgidae

This African bird occurs from Mauritania to Saudi Arabia, and migrates south to Liberia, Congo, and Tanzania.



23 cm
9 in

DUSKY NIGHTJAR*Caprimulgus saturatus*

F: Caprimulgidae

Perhaps genetically closer to American poorwills than Old World nightjars, this species occurs in montane forests of Costa Rica and Panama.



23–28 cm
9–11 in

LADDER-TAILED NIGHTJAR*Hydropsalis climacocera*

F: Caprimulgidae

This Amazonian species belongs to a group of S. American nightjars, in which males have a long, forked tail with white markings. These give the bird its name and are possibly used to attract females.

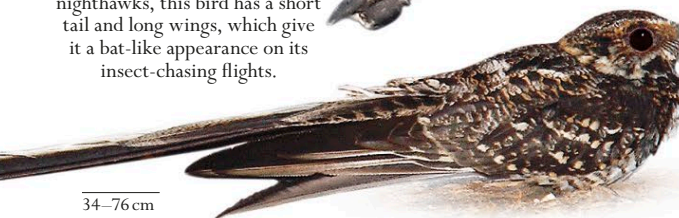


22 cm
9 in

SHORT-TAILED NIGHTHAWK*Lurocalis semitorquatus*

F: Caprimulgidae

One of several tropical American nighthawks, this bird has a short tail and long wings, which give it a bat-like appearance on its insect-chasing flights.



34–76 cm
13½–30 in

LONG-TRAINED NIGHTJAR*Macropsalis creagra*

F: Caprimulgidae

Males of many nightjars have an elaborate tail. This species evolved from tropical American nighthawks and is limited to eastern S. America.



21–23 cm
8½–9 in

flag-like
flight feathers

